

TechMart

Company Policy Handbook

Customer Operations, Shipping, Returns, Warranty & Support Policy

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Reference

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1. Introduction and Scope

This handbook establishes the official policies governing customer accounts, ordering, shipping, returns, refunds, warranty claims, and customer support operations at TechMart ("the Company"). It applies to all purchases made through the Company's website, mobile application, and authorized third-party marketplaces where TechMart products are sold directly by the Company.

This document is intended to be used both as an internal reference for Customer Operations staff and automated support systems, and as a customer-facing reference for understanding their rights and obligations when purchasing from TechMart. Where any conflict exists between this handbook and a jurisdiction's local consumer protection law, the local law takes precedence.

TechMart reserves the right to update this policy at any time. Material changes will be communicated to customers via email and posted with an updated effective date at the top of this document.

2. Definitions

For the purposes of this handbook, the following terms apply:

- **"Order Date"** refers to the date and time an order is confirmed and payment is successfully captured.
- **"Business Day"** refers to Monday through Friday, excluding public holidays observed at the Company's primary distribution center.
- **"Delivery Window"** refers to the estimated delivery date range shown to the customer at checkout.
- **"Eligible Refund"** refers to a refund request that meets one or more of the criteria defined in Section 8 of this handbook.
- **"Human Approval Threshold"** refers to the dollar value above which a refund request must be reviewed by a member of the Customer Operations management team before it is processed, as defined in Section 14.

3. Customer Accounts and Eligibility

Customers must be at least 18 years of age, or the age of legal majority in their jurisdiction, to create an account and place orders with TechMart. Accounts may be created using a valid email address, or through supported third-party single sign-on providers.

Each customer is entitled to maintain one active account. TechMart reserves the right to suspend or terminate accounts found to be in violation of Section 18 (Prohibited Conduct), including accounts created to circumvent a prior suspension.

Customers are responsible for maintaining the confidentiality of their account credentials and for all activity that occurs under their account, whether or not authorized by the customer.

4. Ordering Process and Order Confirmation

An order is considered placed once a customer completes checkout and payment authorization is successful. An automated order confirmation email is sent to the customer's registered email address within minutes of order placement, containing the order ID, itemized contents, and estimated delivery window.

Orders may be modified or canceled free of charge at any point before the order enters the "Processing" status in the Company's fulfillment system. Once an order has moved to "Processing" or later, it can no longer be modified, though it may still be eligible for cancellation and refund under Section 8 if it has not yet shipped.

TechMart reserves the right to cancel any order prior to shipment due to inventory unavailability, pricing errors, or suspected fraudulent activity. In such cases, the customer will be notified and issued a full refund automatically, without requiring a support request.

5. Pricing, Payment, and Taxes

All prices displayed at checkout are in the currency indicated for the customer's storefront region and are inclusive of applicable value-added tax or sales tax unless otherwise noted. TechMart accepts major credit and debit cards, as well as supported regional digital wallets.

In the rare event that a product is listed at an incorrect price due to a technical or typographical error, TechMart reserves the right to cancel the affected order and issue a full refund, even if payment has already been processed.

6. Shipping Methods and Delivery Timelines

TechMart offers three shipping tiers for domestic orders: Standard Delivery, Express Delivery, and Same-Day Delivery. Standard Delivery is the default method selected at checkout and typically delivers within 3 to 5 business days from the order date, excluding weekends and public holidays.

Express Delivery is available for an additional fee at checkout and typically delivers within 1 to 2 business days. Same-Day Delivery is available only in select metropolitan areas for orders placed before 12:00 PM local time, and is subject to courier availability.

Delivery timelines communicated at checkout and in order confirmation emails are estimates based on historical courier performance and are not guaranteed delivery dates. Delays may occur due to courier network congestion, severe weather conditions, customs processing for cross-border shipments, or incomplete or incorrect address information provided by the customer at checkout.

7. Delayed, Lost, and Misdelivered Shipments

An order is considered delayed if it has not been delivered within 7 business days of the order date for Standard Delivery, or within 3 business days of the order date for Express Delivery. If a customer's order status shows "Delayed" for more than 3 calendar days past its originally expected delivery date, Customer Operations should proactively investigate the shipment with the courier partner.

Customers whose orders remain undelivered beyond 7 business days past the promised delivery date are eligible to request either a full refund of the order amount, or a free replacement shipment, at the customer's discretion. This eligibility applies regardless of the underlying cause of the delay, including courier-caused delays, weather events, and customs holds, since TechMart is responsible to the customer for timely fulfillment regardless of which third party is at fault.

An order is considered lost if the courier's tracking information has shown no movement for more than 10 consecutive business days, or if the courier confirms the shipment cannot be located. Lost orders are treated identically to delayed orders for refund eligibility purposes and do not require the customer to wait any further once lost status is confirmed.

A misdelivered order — one confirmed as delivered by the courier but not received by the customer — should first be investigated by checking with neighbors, building management, or household members, and by reviewing delivery photo evidence if available. If the shipment cannot be located within 5 business days of the confirmed delivery date, it is treated as lost for refund purposes.

8. Return and Refund Eligibility

A customer is eligible for a full refund or free replacement under any of the following conditions:

Condition	Resolution
Order not delivered within 7 business days of promised date	Full refund or free replacement

Item arrives damaged, defective, or does not power on	Full refund or free replacement
Incorrect item shipped (wrong product, size, or color)	Full refund or free replacement
Order canceled before it ships from the warehouse	Full refund, no restocking fee
Order confirmed lost by courier (no movement 10+ business days)	Full refund or free replacement
Change of mind after delivery (unopened, within 14 days)	Store credit only, 10% restocking fee applies

Because TechMart has no independent means of physically inspecting an item before a refund decision is made, a customer's own report of damage, defect, or an incorrect item at the time of a support request is treated as valid grounds for refund eligibility under this policy, subject to the same human approval threshold that applies to all refunds (see Section 14).

9. Non-Returnable and Excluded Items

The following categories are not eligible for return or refund under any circumstance, except in cases of confirmed manufacturing defect:

- Gift cards and store credit balances
- Digital downloads and software license keys once redeemed
- Personal care and hygiene items that have been opened
- Custom-configured or personalized products
- Items marked "Final Sale" at the time of purchase

10. Manufacturer Warranty Coverage

All electronic products sold by TechMart carry a standard 12-month limited manufacturer warranty beginning on the date of delivery, unless a longer warranty period is explicitly stated on the product listing at the time of purchase. This warranty covers defects in materials and workmanship that arise under normal use conditions.

- Manufacturing defects present at the time of delivery
- Component failure occurring under normal, intended use
- Battery capacity degradation below 80% within the first 12 months, for battery-powered devices
- Software or firmware defects originating from the manufacturer

11. Warranty Exclusions

The warranty does not cover damage or malfunction resulting from any of the following:

- Accidental damage, including drops, spills, or exposure to liquid
- Unauthorized repair, disassembly, or modification by a non-TechMart technician
- Normal wear and tear, including cosmetic scratches or fading
- Use of the product outside its intended purpose or manufacturer guidelines
- Damage caused by third-party accessories, chargers, or peripherals not approved by TechMart
- Products with the serial number removed, defaced, or altered

12. Filing a Warranty Claim

To file a warranty claim, the customer must provide their original order ID, a description of the defect, and, where applicable, photographic or video evidence of the issue. Claims are reviewed by the Customer Operations team within 2 business days of submission.

Approved warranty claims result in either a free repair, a free replacement unit of the same or an equivalent model, or store credit equal to the original purchase price, at TechMart's sole discretion based

on part availability and product age at the time of the claim.

13. Damaged or Defective Items on Arrival

Items reported as damaged, defective, or incorrect immediately upon arrival are treated under the refund eligibility rules in Section 8 rather than under the standard warranty claim process in Sections 10 through 12, since these are considered fulfillment issues rather than product lifetime failures. Customers should be offered a full refund or free replacement without requiring the evidentiary process used for later-occurring warranty claims, though photo evidence may still be requested for internal quality tracking purposes.

14. Refund Processing and Human Approval Thresholds

To protect against fraudulent claims and ensure financial accuracy, refunds valued at \$50.00 USD or greater require review and sign-off from a member of the Customer Operations management team before processing. Refunds valued under \$50.00 USD may be approved and processed automatically by the support system without additional review, provided the claim meets one of the eligibility conditions listed in Section 8.

Approved refunds are typically credited back to the customer's original payment method within 5 to 7 business days of approval. Store credit issued under the "change of mind" policy is applied instantly and does not require management approval regardless of order value, since it does not involve a reversal of real payment funds.

Requests referencing an order ID that cannot be located in the Company's order database must never be escalated for approval or have a refund promised, since there is no verified order to approve a refund against. Such requests should be met with a request for the customer to verify their order details.

15. Customer Support Channels and Response Times

Customers may reach Customer Operations via email, live chat, or the automated support assistant available on the TechMart website and mobile application. The automated assistant is authorized to resolve routine order status, refund eligibility, and warranty policy inquiries without human intervention, escalating only when a request meets the human approval threshold defined in Section 14 or falls outside the scope of documented policy.

Standard email and chat inquiries receive an initial response within 24 hours on business days. Requests flagged as high priority or urgent under Section 16 are prioritized for response within 4 business hours.

16. Sentiment Escalation and Priority Handling

Customer Operations, including automated support systems, should classify incoming requests by sentiment (positive, neutral, negative, or angry) and priority (low, medium, high, or urgent) to ensure appropriate response times and staffing. Requests expressing genuine frustration, repeated unresolved contact attempts, or explicit demands should be classified as high or urgent priority regardless of the underlying policy eligibility of the request itself.

Every incoming request should be logged as a support ticket for tracking and quality purposes, including low-priority and neutral-sentiment requests, to maintain a complete record of customer contact history.

17. Privacy and Data Protection

TechMart collects and processes customer data solely for the purposes of order fulfillment, customer support, fraud prevention, and, where explicitly consented to, marketing communications. Customer payment information is processed through PCI-DSS compliant third-party payment processors and is not stored directly on TechMart servers.

Customers may request access to, correction of, or deletion of their personal data at any time by contacting Customer Operations, subject to legal retention requirements for order and financial records.

18. Prohibited Conduct and Account Suspension

TechMart reserves the right to suspend or terminate any customer account found to be engaging in fraudulent refund claims, repeated abuse of the return policy, harassment of support staff, or attempts to manipulate automated support systems into approving requests that do not meet documented policy criteria.

19. Dispute Resolution

Customers who disagree with a refund or warranty decision made by Customer Operations may request a secondary review by a senior member of the Customer Operations management team. If a resolution cannot be reached, disputes are subject to the arbitration and governing law provisions outlined in the Company's general Terms of Service.

20. Limitation of Liability

TechMart's liability under this policy is limited to the repair, replacement, refund, or store credit remedies described herein. TechMart is not liable for incidental, consequential, or indirect damages arising from product use, product failure, or shipment delay, including but not limited to loss of data, loss of use, or lost business opportunity.

21. Changes to This Policy

TechMart may revise this handbook at any time to reflect changes in business operations, applicable law, or service offerings. The effective date at the top of this document reflects the date of the most recent revision. Continued use of TechMart's services after a policy update constitutes acceptance of the revised terms.

22. Contact Information

For questions regarding this handbook, customers may contact Customer Operations through the support channels described in Section 15. Internal staff should refer questions about policy interpretation to the Customer Operations management team.

23. Regional Shipping and Customs Considerations

Delivery timelines vary by region due to differences in courier network density, customs processing requirements, and local public holidays. The table below provides typical Standard Delivery windows by region; these figures are used for setting customer expectations and are separate from the policy-defined 7 business day delay threshold in Section 7, which applies uniformly regardless of region.

Region	Typical Standard Delivery Window
North America (domestic)	3 to 5 business days
Europe (domestic)	2 to 4 business days
United Kingdom	2 to 4 business days
Asia-Pacific (domestic)	3 to 6 business days
Cross-border / international	7 to 14 business days, subject to customs

Cross-border orders may be subject to import duties, customs fees, or value-added tax levied by the destination country, which are the responsibility of the customer unless the order listing explicitly states duties-paid shipping. Customs holds do not extend the policy-defined delay threshold; the 7 business day refund eligibility window in Section 7 still applies regardless of customs processing time, since TechMart remains responsible to the customer for timely fulfillment.

24. Product Category-Specific Warranty Terms

While Section 10 establishes the standard 12-month warranty baseline, certain product categories carry adjusted terms as described below. Where a category-specific term conflicts with the general warranty in Section 10, the category-specific term takes precedence.

24.1 Wearable Devices

Wearable devices, including smartwatches and fitness trackers, carry a 12-month warranty on internal electronics and a 6-month warranty on the strap, band, or other consumable accessory components, which are considered normal-wear items outside of the electronics warranty period.

24.2 Major Appliances

Major appliances carry an extended 24-month warranty on the primary compressor, motor, or heating element, and a standard 12-month warranty on all other components, consistent with Section 10.

24.3 Furniture and Non-Electronic Goods

Furniture and other non-electronic goods are not covered under the standard electronics warranty described in Section 10, but instead carry a 24-month structural defect warranty covering frame, joint, and hardware failure under normal household use. Upholstery fabric wear is not covered.

24.4 Refurbished and Open-Box Items

Products sold under the "Certified Refurbished" or "Open-Box" listing categories carry a reduced 6-month warranty period in place of the standard 12-month term, reflecting their pre-owned or previously returned condition. All other warranty terms, exclusions, and claim procedures described in Sections 10 through 12 apply equally to refurbished and open-box items.

25. Internal Escalation Matrix

The following matrix summarizes how Customer Operations staff and automated support systems should route requests based on refund value and eligibility status, consolidating the rules described in Sections 8 and 14 into a single reference table.

Refund Value	Eligible Under Section 8	Action
Under \$50	Yes	Process automatically, no approval needed
Under \$50	No	Deny with policy-based explanation
\$50 or more	Yes	Log for human approval before processing
\$50 or more	No	Deny with policy-based explanation; do not escalate
Any amount	Order not found in system	Request customer verify order details; do not escalate or promise refund

26. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: My order hasn't arrived yet, how long should I wait before contacting support?

A: You should wait until your order is past its estimated delivery window shown at checkout. If it shows as "Delayed" for more than 3 days past that date, or if it has been more than 7 business days since your order date for Standard Delivery, you are eligible to contact support for a refund or replacement.

Q: Do I need to return a damaged item before getting a refund?

A: No. For items reported as damaged, defective, or incorrect on arrival, TechMart does not require the item to be shipped back before issuing a refund or replacement, since return shipping costs would outweigh the value in most cases.

Q: Why do some refunds need approval and others don't?

A: Refunds of \$50 or more require a brief human review to prevent fraudulent claims and ensure financial accuracy. Refunds under \$50 can be processed automatically since the financial risk is lower.

Q: Can I get a refund if I simply don't want the item anymore?

A: Yes, but only within 14 days of delivery and only if the item is unopened. In this case you will receive store credit rather than a cash refund, and a 10% restocking fee applies.

Q: What happens if my order shows as delivered but I never received it?

A: First check with neighbors, building management, or other household members, and review any delivery photo evidence provided by the courier. If the package cannot be located within 5 business days of the confirmed delivery date, it is treated as a lost shipment and you are eligible for a refund or replacement.

Q: Does the warranty cover accidental damage, like dropping my device?

A: No. The manufacturer warranty covers defects in materials and workmanship under normal use, but explicitly excludes accidental damage such as drops, spills, or liquid exposure.

Q: How long does a warranty claim take to review?

A: Warranty claims are typically reviewed within 2 business days of submission, provided the required order ID and description of the defect are included.

Q: Is there a difference between a warranty claim and a damaged-on-arrival claim?

A: Yes. Damaged-on-arrival claims are treated as fulfillment issues under the refund eligibility rules in Section 8, while warranty claims relate to a defect that develops after a period of normal use and follow the process in Sections 10 through 12.

Q: Can TechMart cancel my order after I've paid for it?

A: Yes, in limited circumstances — such as inventory unavailability, a pricing error, or suspected fraud. In all such cases you will be automatically issued a full refund without needing to contact support.

Q: Do refurbished or open-box items have the same return policy as new items?

A: Yes, the return and refund eligibility rules in Section 8 apply equally to refurbished and open-box items. Only the warranty duration differs, at 6 months instead of the standard 12.

Q: What information do I need to provide when contacting support about a refund?

A: Your order ID is the most important piece of information, along with a brief description of the issue (e.g. late delivery, damaged item, wrong item). For warranty claims, photo or video evidence of the defect is also requested.

27. Document Revision History

Version	Date	Summary of Changes
1.0	2023-03-01	Initial publication of company policy handbook
2.0	2024-01-15	Added warranty claim procedures and category-specific terms
3.0	2025-06-01	Introduced \$50 human approval threshold for refunds
4.0	2026-01-01	Added lost shipment and misdelivery provisions; expanded FAQ and escalation matrix

28. Extended Glossary

Chargeback: A payment reversal initiated by a customer's bank or card issuer, separate from a TechMart-issued refund, and handled through the Payments team rather than Customer Operations.

Fulfillment Center: A TechMart-operated or third-party-operated warehouse from which customer orders are packed and dispatched to couriers.

Order Status: The current stage of an order in the fulfillment lifecycle: Processing, Shipped, In Transit, Delivered, Delayed, or Canceled.

Restocking Fee: A fee deducted from a refund or store credit amount to cover the cost of processing a returned item, applied only to change-of-mind returns as described in Section 8.

Store Credit: A non-cash balance applied to a customer's account that can be used toward future purchases, issued in place of a cash refund for change-of-mind returns.